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THE TIMES OF INDIA

Govt hosps in Garhwa face acute staff crunch

Aug 29, 2025, 11:31 PM IST



Garhwa: The govt hospitals in Garhwa district are grappling with a severe staff shortage at various levels. There are a total of 65 doctors, including regular and NHM, working across the district against the sanctioned 189 posts, while 124 posts for doctors are lying vacant.

Garhwa district has a population of more than 15 lakh, of which around 14,79,000 people live in rural areas. In contrast, the Garhwa urban area has a population of around 55,000. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), there should be at least one doctor per 1,000 people. Contrary to this, only one doctor is available for 40,000 people in Garhwa district.

The situation of nursing staff is similar, as only four nursing staff are currently working against 44 sanctioned posts. Similarly, only four medical officers are working against seven sanctioned posts, and eight specialist medical officers are working against a total of 42 posts. The situation can be further understood by noting that 162 posts for regular ANM and NHM are lying vacant. Similarly, 105 posts for regular GNM and NHM are lying vacant. Civil surgeon Dr John F Kennedy said, "There is an acute shortage of doctors. The govt has been apprised of the situation time and again, but the issue is yet to be addressed. Hence, doctors have an excess workload. Duties are being managed anyhow to provide better treatment to the patients."